

# Santiago A. Ruiz Diaz

OT/ICS Cybersecurity Analyst | Security+ • CySA+ • PenTest+ | 15+ Yrs Critical Infrastructure

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## PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Cybersecurity professional with 15+ years of hands-on experience operating Operational Technology (OT) and Industrial Control Systems (ICS) — including Building Management Systems (BMS), SCADA-like controllers, PLC-driven systems, and BACnet networks. Now applying that field-level OT knowledge directly in cybersecurity operations.

Most cybersecurity analysts have never touched a PLC or walked a server room monitoring a BACnet controller. I have — for 16 years. That operational context shapes how I approach threat detection, anomaly analysis, and incident response across IT and OT environments.

Currently working as a Security Engineer I at LOGN Pacific, delivering hands-on projects in Microsoft Sentinel, Defender for Endpoint, Tenable vulnerability management, and threat hunting — while completing my B.S. in Cybersecurity & Information Assurance at Western Governors University. Actively pursuing a Master's degree in Cybersecurity, with enrollment planned for mid-2026.

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## CORE COMPETENCIES

SIEM • Threat Hunting • Incident Response • Log Analysis • Vulnerability Assessment • OT/ICS Security • SCADA • PLC • GCL+ • BACnet • BMS • Network Security • Access Control • System Hardening • Risk Assessment • Python • PowerShell • Bash • KQL • Microsoft Sentinel • Microsoft Defender for Endpoint • Tenable / Nessus • Azure Security • MITRE ATT&CK • DISA STIG

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## CERTIFICATIONS

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|-------------------------------------------------|---------|----------|----------|
| CompTIA PenTest+                                | CompTIA | Mar 2026 | Mar 2029 |
| CompTIA CySA+ ce                                | CompTIA | Aug 2025 | Aug 2031 |
| CompTIA Security+ ce                            | CompTIA | Jul 2025 | Jul 2028 |
| CompTIA Network+ ce                             | CompTIA | Jul 2025 | Jul 2028 |
| CompTIA A+ ce                                   | CompTIA | May 2025 | Aug 2031 |
| CompTIA Secure Infrastructure Specialist – CSIS | CompTIA | Jul 2025 | Jul 2028 |
| CompTIA IT Operations Specialist – CIOS         | CompTIA | Jul 2025 | Jul 2028 |
| Linux Essentials Certificate                    | LPI     | May 2025 | —        |
| ITIL Foundation                                 | AXELOS  | —        | —        |

## EXPERIENCE

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### LOGN Pacific

Security Engineer I • Internship • March 2026 – Present

Hands-on security engineering role delivering threat detection, vulnerability management, and incident investigation across Microsoft Azure, Microsoft Sentinel, Defender for Endpoint, and Tenable.

#### ► Vulnerability Management Program (Tenable)

- Implemented a full VM lifecycle across a ~200-server enterprise environment using Tenable — authenticated and unauthenticated scans on Windows Server 2025 and Linux with DISA STIG scan templates.
- Prioritized findings by CVSS score, asset criticality, and exposure — NTLMv1 disable, SMB signing, TLS 1.0/1.1, and weak ciphers.
- Built PowerShell scripts to remediate vulnerabilities on Windows servers and Bash scripts for Linux server remediation at scale.
- Facilitated CAB meetings, drafted VM policy, and drove executive sign-off and server team buy-in.

#### ► Signal After The Noise — Post-Intrusion Threat Hunt (Microsoft Sentinel)

- Reconstructed a full adversary attack chain in Microsoft Sentinel across a simulated enterprise environment.
- Authored 20+ KQL queries across 6 MDE log tables: DeviceLogonEvents, DeviceProcessEvents, DeviceFileEvents, DeviceNetworkEvents, DeviceRegistryEvents, and DeviceEvents.
- Mapped full kill chain: T1078 (credential reuse) → T1021 (RDP lateral movement) → T1547.001 (persistence) → T1071.001 (C2 beaconing) → T1562.001 (AMSI evasion) → T1036 (LOLBin masquerade) → T1003.001 (LSASS credential dump).
- Decoded Base64-encoded PowerShell payloads using KQL's `base64_decode_tostring()` to expose Cloudflare-fronted C2 infrastructure.
- Produced full IOC table and MITRE ATT&CK-mapped incident report.

#### ► TOR Network Detection (Microsoft Defender for Endpoint)

- Confirmed unauthorized TOR browser usage on a corporate Azure Windows 11 endpoint via KQL across DeviceFileEvents, DeviceProcessEvents, and DeviceNetworkEvents.
- Detected full TOR circuit — `tor.exe` to external relay on port 9001, `firefox.exe` from non-standard Desktop path to evade registry traces, suspicious file created and deleted to conceal activity.
- Mapped to MITRE T1090.003, T1204, T1036. Delivered incident report with device isolation, HR/legal escalation, and perimeter block of TOR ports 9001–9151.

## County College of Morris

HVAC & Building Automation Systems Specialist | OT/ICS Operations • November 2010 – Present (15+ years)

Operating and maintaining critical building infrastructure across a network-connected campus — working directly with OT/ICS systems, SCADA-like controllers, BACnet-connected devices, and PLC-driven building automation across HVAC, boilers, and electrical infrastructure.

### ► System Monitoring & Incident Escalation

- Monitored operational integrity of networked control systems, identifying abnormal behavior and system anomalies across electronic controls and BACnet-connected devices.
- Identified and escalated potential risks and unresolvable issues to appropriate teams, supporting system reliability and continuity of campus operations.
- Collaborated with leadership to align operations with organizational security policies and change management processes.

### ► PLC Scripting & System Maintenance

- Maintained, troubleshooted, and repaired GCL+ PLC scripts across SCADA-like controllers and building automation systems — resolving logic errors and escalating issues beyond scope to appropriate technical teams.
- Made configuration changes and system adjustments as needed via BMS client terminal to maintain operational integrity across HVAC, boilers, and electrical infrastructure.

### ► Access Control & Identity Management

- Administered access control for building automation systems via BMS client terminal — provisioning, modifying, and revoking user permissions for internal staff using least-privilege principles.
- Conducted periodic access reviews to ensure authorization aligned with current roles and responsibilities.

## EDUCATION

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### Master's Degree in Cybersecurity (*Planned*)

Actively pursuing enrollment — expected start mid-2026

Target start: July – August 2026

### Western Governors University

Bachelor of Science, Cybersecurity & Information Assurance (BSCSIA)

March 2025 – March 2026

### Thomas Edison State University

Coursework — Electronics & Electrical Engineering Technology (*Degree not completed*)

2014 – 2017

## PROJECTS

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Full documentation: [github.com/Santi4g0RD](https://github.com/Santi4g0RD)

|                                  |                                      |                                                                                                                                                             |
|----------------------------------|--------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Vulnerability Management Program | Tenable, PowerShell, Bash            | Full VM lifecycle across ~200-server enterprise — scanning, prioritization, remediation on Windows and Linux servers, policy, and stakeholder coordination. |
| Signal After The Noise           | Microsoft Sentinel, KQL              | Post-intrusion threat hunt reconstructing full adversary kill chain across 6 MDE log tables, mapped to MITRE ATT&CK.                                        |
| TOR Network Detection            | Microsoft Defender for Endpoint, KQL | Detection and investigation of unauthorized TOR usage on corporate endpoint. Full IOC documentation and incident report.                                    |

## LANGUAGES

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English — Native / Bilingual | Spanish — Native / Bilingual